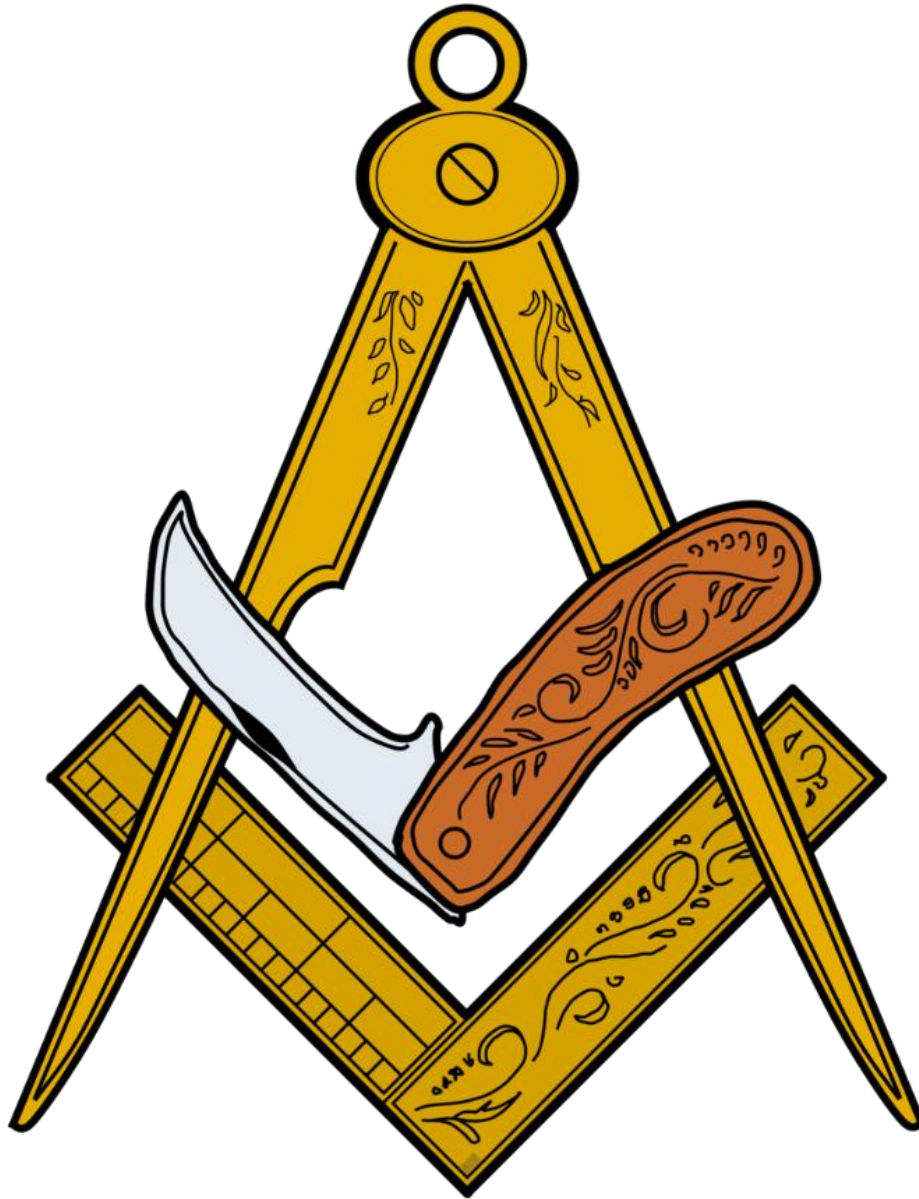


SECOND DEGREE LECTURE

THE FREE GARDENER JOURNEYMAN



[Authorized by the United Council, A.O.F.G., Inc.]

The Arrangement of the Garden [the Lodge]

In the Journeyman degree, several symbolic elements are arranged before the ceremonial opening:

- The serpent and the letter “A” (representing Adam) are placed in the northwest section of the working carpet.
- Three concentric rings now lie at the center, where the serpent was positioned during the Apprentice degree.
- The initials of the four paradisiacal rivers—Pishon, Gihon, Hiddekel (Tigris), and Euphrates (PGHE)—are already in place.
- Notably, the white rose has been moved from the “Altar in the West,” where it previously laid beside the red and pink roses and the olive branch, and now rests on the table of the Emissary Master.

The Symbolism of the Three Roses

In the Apprentice degree, the three roses are introduced during the Free Gardener’s fourfold journey:

- “expresses the innocence and purity of metaphorical gardening, which is characterized by the constant labor and moral training”
- “The blood-red color of the rose expresses love, which, along with faith and hope, is the greatest among them” (1 Corinthians 13:13).
- “The pink rose expresses the life of creativity that comes from the intimate communion of goodness and love.”

Though only love is explicitly associated with the red rose, the divine virtues—faith, hope, and love—are present. In this interpretation:

- The pink rose symbolizes *faith*,
- The white rose symbolizes *hope*,
- The red rose symbolizes *love*.

Though not directly stated in the Apprentice degree, this symbolism can be inferred: Hope (white), Love (red), and Faith (pink) together suggest that faith arises from the union of love and hope [white + red = pink]. The transfer of the white rose to the Emissary Master’s table signifies that something from the Garden of Paradise (W. Altar) has been sent into the lodge (rectangle)—beyond the square of the paradisiacal garden. This represents hope: that “the pure white color of

the rose—that is, the innocence and purity of metaphorical gardening—will pass on to the Free Gardener through diligent labor and moral discipline.”

Ceremonial Closure and the Role of Signs

During the closing of the metaphorical garden:

- The Chaplain removes the letters A and N (symbolizing Adam and Noah) and the three concentric circles, restoring the serpent to the center.
- The four river initials are then removed.
- Finally, the white rose is returned to the “Altar in the West,” restoring the Apprentice degree's original arrangement.

We refer to degree transitions as “admissions” because we always remain apprentices. Each degree is layered within us, never abandoned. Thus, at the opening of the Journeyman degree, both the Apprentice sign and the Journeyman sign are required. Yet it is the Emissary Master—not the Worthy Master—who requests them. The Emissary Master’s role is to examine seekers, instruct them, and ensure all present are Free Gardeners of the correct degree. No signs are requested during the closing, as both degrees remain “unsealed” within us.

Remembrance, the White Rose, and Divine Origin

When the Emissary Master presents the “General Obligations” of the Journeyman to the apprentices, he holds the white rose and remarks: “A fragrance is the strongest means of remembrance.”

In that moment, apprentices may not realize he is addressing all of us. Him (Emissary Master), the rose, and the fragrance are emissaries sent from the square Garden of Paradise into the rectangular lodge to remind us of our origin. According to Free Gardener teachings, all humankind—not just Adam and Eve—originates from the Garden of Paradise. This reminder of divine origin is subtle but profound, passed through scent, symbol, and presence.

The Sash and the Number Eight

These elements (scent, symbol and presence) prepare the way for the ceremonial moment when the Worthy Master places the sash—a “star-studded heavenly sign”—upon the candidate. Once invested, the sash may be worn beyond the garden and the lodge, marking the wearer publicly as a Free Gardener and as a representative of the Order, especially of our mother lodge.

During its presentation, the following symbolism is presented:

“Just as God placed the sign of the covenant—the rainbow—upon the heavens like a sash, so do I adorn you with this star-studded sign of hope.”

Regarding the star on the sash

“The eight-pointed star reminds a Free Gardener that he must always be noble and courteous, no matter where the eight winds carry him.”

The reference to the number eight recalls the Anemoi (ἄνεμοι)—the Greek winds. Their correspondences are shown below:

Wind Direction	Name	Pronunciation	Representation	Lodge Seating
North	Boreas	BOH-ray-as	Man with cloak, blowing into a shell	Secretary and Chaplain
Northeast	Kaikias	KAI-kee-as	Man pouring hailstones from a round shield	Apprentice
East	Apheliotes	ah-fee-lee-OH-tees	Young man with a cloak full of fruits and grain	Worthy Master
Southeast	Euros	YOO-ros	Elder wrapped in a cloak	Journeyman
South	Notos	NOH-tos	Man pouring from a jug	Rentmaster and Instruction Master
Southwest	Lips	LEEPS	Young man holding a ship's stern (prow)	Master Gardener
West	Zephyros	ZEF-ee-ros	Youn man with a cloak full of flowers	Emissary Master
Northwest	Skiron	SKEE-ron	Bearded man with bronze vessel of charcoal and hot ashes	Past Master

the number eight is also emblematic of the eight days of creation, the symbol of infinity, but also, a reference to the eight Beatitudes from the Sermon on the Mount (Mathew 5:1-7:29) taught by Jesus of Nazareth, who in the Free Garden is considered the last of the free gardeners.

Here are the **Eight Beatitudes** from Jesus' *Sermon on the Mount*, found in **Matthew 5:3–10 (NIV)**. Each begins with “Blessed are...” and offers a spiritual promise:

1. **Blessed are the poor in spirit,**
for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.
→ Humility before God opens the way to divine enlightenment.
2. **Blessed are those who mourn,**
for they will be comforted.
→ Sorrow, especially over sin or suffering, invites divine consolation.
3. **Blessed are the meek,**
for they will inherit the earth.
→ Gentle strength and self-control lead to lasting reward.

4. **Blessed are those who hunger and thirst for righteousness,**
for they will be filled.
→ A deep longing for justice and virtue is satisfied by God.
5. **Blessed are the merciful,**
for they will be shown mercy.
→ Compassion toward others reflects and receives divine grace.
6. **Blessed are the pure in heart,**
for they will see God.
→ Inner integrity and sincerity reveal the divine.
7. **Blessed are the peacemakers,**
for they will be called children of God.
→ Those who foster harmony mirror the nature of the divine family.
8. **Blessed are those who are persecuted because of righteousness,**
for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.
→ Enduring hardship for virtue aligns one with the eternal realm.

Symbolism from the “Story of the First Free Gardener After the Flood,” is not only evident in our degree ceremonies but also in the structure of the lodge in general:

“Noah, his wife, and their three sons—Shem, Japheth, and Ham—and their wives practiced metaphorical gardening aboard the Ark. Noah was the Worthy Master, which is why he is considered the first gardener after the Flood. Long afterwards, the emerging Free Gardener Lodges were formed from eight Keepers; for it takes one Master to form a Lodge, four Masters to hold a Lodge meeting, and eight Masters and Keepers to carry out admissions.”

In the Apprentice degree, we are reminded that God created Eve from Adam’s rib, giving him a partner who stood beside him as his equal. A similar idea emerges in the account of the Flood, where the first Free Gardener Lodge consisted of four women and four men working together.

Second Degree Lecture: The Oral Tradition

The second degree stands out for its interpretation of the Flood story and the experiences of Noah. In human terms, Noah and his family lived through the complete destruction of their social world—every relative, every friend, every familiar structure was swept away. Scripture presents Noah as a grower of vines and later as a man who succumbed to drunkenness, but it does not address what emotional or psychological burdens might have led him there. The second-degree ceremony... “The Story of the First Free Gardener after the Flood,” explores this in depth.

Noah was born under the words of his father, Lamech:

“He will comfort us in the labor and painful toil of our hands caused by the ground the Lord has cursed.” (Genesis 5:29, NIV)

This directly tied to the word and motto of the second degree, where the Worthy Master says:

“My esteemed brothers and sisters, I will now induct you into our community as a Free Gardener-Journeyman. This degree is the midpoint but also the unifying degree. We call it the Degree of C----- . For this reason, the Hebrew word N----- was chosen as its motto, which means “to c----- or c-----”, and refers to the word of this degree, ---- (Genesis 5:29). The Word and Motto of this degree together means “---- c-----” or “---- c-----”

This theme also reaches back to Adam and Eve, whose choices brought the curse upon humanity. By the biblical timeline, Noah stands out as the first patriarch who never met Adam face-to-face. Because the early patriarchs lived so long, their lives overlapped in remarkable ways, allowing scholars to trace who knew whom. As the tenth generation, Noah inherited only stories—no direct memory—of his earliest ancestor.

This makes oral tradition essential. Just as Noah relied on the stories handed down to him, Free Gardeners carry their heritage forward through the spoken word.

Noah’s sorrow, survivor’s guilt, and longing for a lost world—expressed in his drunkenness—are considered alongside the reactions of his sons. Ham’s disrespect and the quiet reverence of Shem and Japheth offer enduring lessons in conduct. Their responses reflect the core virtues of unity and moral integrity that sustain the Order, whose future depends on remaining faithful to these principles.

The Apron as Explained in the Journeyman Degree

The Apron’s Fourfold Foundation

- **Color & Symbolism:** The dark base represents the darkness of ignorance, as in your Apprentice stage.
- **Four Quadrants:** Each holds four symbols—representing the Four Elements and the Four Kingdoms of Nature.
- These mirror **Four Realms:** Galactic, Planetary, Celestial, and Terrestrial. Though all elements exist in each, one dominates them all.

The Flap and Transcendent Knowledge

- On the **flap:** The **All-Seeing Eye**, alongside the Compass, Square, Pruning Knife.
- The **All-Seeing Eye** reflects divine omnipresence—“The eyes of the Lord are everywhere, keeping watch on the wicked and the good” (*Proverbs 15:3, NIV*).
- These tools mark the Gardener’s mission of refinement and alignment—both spiritual and practical.

The Rivers and the Virtues

- Four letters represent the **Edenic rivers:** Pishon, Gihon, Hiddekel (Tigris), and Euphrates (*cf. Genesis 2:10–14*).
- Spiritually, they correspond to the Free Gardener’s core virtues: **Love, Wisdom, Harmony, Truth.**

S.O.N.A and the Trees

- These initials stand for **Solomon, Noah, Adam, and Olive**—the last representing peace and rebirth.
- The **olive tree**, not the apple, better represents the **Tree of Knowledge**, drawing from biblical symbolism and oral traditions.
- “The dove returned... with a freshly plucked olive leaf” (*Genesis 8:11, NIV*)

The Symbols of Renewal

- On the lower apron: the **Ark, Rainbow, Dove, and Olive branch**—each linked to Noah’s narrative (*Genesis 7–9, NIV*).
- These affirm your covenant with renewal and care.

The Sash and the Winds

- You now wear a **dark blue sash**, trimmed in gold, bearing an eight-pointed star at heart level.
- Within the star lie the tools—Compass, Square, Pruning Knife—reminding you to “remain noble and courteous, no matter which of the eight winds may guide your path.”
- This sash may be worn publicly, with the **Worthy Master’s** permission, symbolizing noble conduct and visible dedication.

The Circles of the Carpet

- Three concentric circles guide you:
 - **Outer:** the world.
 - **Middle:** the Order.
 - **Inner:** the individual [you].
- Like Noah gathering seeds along Eden’s streams, a Free Gardener’s task is twofold:
- Cultivate the **outer garden [external]** with skill and care (stewardship of nature and service to mankind).
- Tend the **inner garden [internal]** through virtue and consolation (self-reflection, mindfulness, meditation, holistic health/healing).